Department of Curriculum and Instruction
M.A. Plan B Final Project Requirements and Examples

Plan B paper(s) may build more directly from coursework; papers should involve deep engagement of the research literature, e.g., an in-depth pursuit of a topic generated from course work; an analysis/synthesis of the research literature. A paper done for a course may serve as one of the Plan B papers, with the understanding that it would be extended and revised under the supervision of the adviser to serve as a Plan B paper. For example, a student could collect data on a project done for a course (e.g., software design, curriculum development, test or assessment instrument). The Plan B Project(s):

- requires a 3-credit "Problems" course (course number varies by program area)
- results in one or two papers involving a combined total of approximately 120 hours of work
- if one paper, should be approximately 40-60 pages, divided into sections. If two, each should be approximately 20-30 pages.
- requires a proposal, which must be approved by the adviser before work on the paper(s) begins
- may or may not involve human subjects (IRB) approval
- final copy is *not* submitted to the Graduate School, but most students present members of the committee with a bound copy

Plan B Project Proposal:

Suggested contents of the Plan B Proposal include the following:

Purpose of the Project
- Description of the project and the purpose of and rationale for the project.

Literature Review
- Preliminary outline of the literature related to your proposed project.

Proposed "Method"
- Include information on the teaching context if applicable (i.e. number of students, type, setting, school, type of course, etc.)
- A written description of your project plan including the research question (if applicable) and a description of at least one data source (if applicable).

Appendix
- If applicable, Human Subjects Application (see below)

Final Project Text:

Suggested contents for the final Plan B project(s) include the following:

Abstract
- A one-paragraph description of your project. Less than 200 words

Purpose of and Rationale for the Project/Inquiry
- Description of the project and the purpose of and rationale for the project.

Literature Review

- Critical overview of the literature related to your project.

Description of the Project

- Include information on the teaching context if applicable (i.e. number of students, type, setting, school, type of course, etc.)
- A written description of your project plan including goals, content, method(s) used, how you analyzed your data (if applicable).

Description of the Results and Implications

- Description of what you learned from the project and the implications for teaching and future research

Bibliography, Resources and Appendices (if applicable)

- Include full bibliographic information for all of the sources cited and resources used.
- If applicable, copy of the approval letter from the U of MN IRB.

Example of Projects Showing Plan B Effort and Quality:

A teacher creates a series of alternative assessments for foreign language classrooms (as part of a course on testing and assessment) and decides to try them out with her students and seek their responses. She's interested in exploring whether the alternative (performance) assessments have an impact on students' motivation and attitudes toward language learning. The paper involves an in-depth literature review on alternative assessment in foreign language teaching and motivation and attitudes toward language learning. The assessments that were designed are included along with a synthesis of the data gathered from students. (involves IRB approval)